



Traditional International Taekwon-do Federation

# Black Belt Manual

Version 1.2, May 2020

The TITF was made for everyone, young, old, male, female, and is not bound to once single system of Taekwon-Do. The world of Taekwon-Do has two major systems, Olympic and Traditional. Traditional system was created by the founder as a means of self defense, physical fitness and a means to better yourself spiritually, and mentally. The Olympic system holds many of the same values however is primarily designed as a martial sport for the Olympics. Therefore the training and techniques between the systems can differ in many ways. This does not make any one system better than the other. The differences are what make us strong. Allowing the differences to flourish attracts new members to both the schools and the organizations. The end goal is Taekwon-Do for everyone.

A lot of people ask are we an ITF organization or a Kukkiwon affiliated organization. The answer is we accepts all Taekwon-Do systems. The founder, Grand Master Dafyd Haase, was a student of the Taekwon-Do founder General Choi Hong Hi, and a 9th Degree Black Belt in the ITF system. The ITF had a policy of excepting any martial artist from any system. They would accept and convert them to the ITF system. Grand Master Haase felt this was a step in the right direction. However to truly appeal to all Taekwon-Do stylists he felt that converting these students and instructors was not the answer. The best thing would be to accept them with their current system and rank. That way everyone could continue to train and advance with no set backs and all under the umbrella of one organization. One Taekwon-Do. To Grand Master Haase the moral code was the most important element, not the techniques.

Anyone wishing to switch arts, lets say from Karate to Taekwon-Do, get a one time conversion at current rank. So a 2nd Dan in Karate can come over and automatically get 2nd Dan in Taekwon-Do. Master ranks would need approval of Grand Master Haase .

TaeKwon!

Grand Master Dafyd Andrew Haase  
9th Dan, CAN-9-01, TITF President

This handbook contains the requirements for each degree (dan) as laid down by the Traditional International Taekwon-Do Federation (TITF). It is designed to provide a basic reference source, and a guideline for testing up to 6th degree black belt. School owners and Certified TITF Instructors can use International Taekwon-Do Federation (ITF) or World Taekwondo (WT) Kukkiwon Yundanja for patterns requirement. Promotion to 7th degree and above is governed and controlled directly by the TITF President Grand Master Dafyd Andrew Haase 9th Dan, CAN-9-01.

The majority of material in this handbook was obtained from the Encyclopaedia of Taekwon-Do by General Choi Hong Hi, Founder of Taekwon-Do.

Students should know the theory of all levels below their own plus have a good general knowledge of Taekwon-Do and the organization of TITF and ITF or WT Kukkiwon style system of TKD. This information can be found on the TITF, ITF, and Kukkiwon websites.

I wish to acknowledge the valuable assistance of Ms. Nicole Jefferson, 1st Dan of Jefferson Taekwon-Do club, in the preparation of this booklet.

Master Lawrence Jefferson  
7th Dan USA-SFKLFM-2019, T.I.T.F

## **Special Instructions:**

### **Uniforms:**

- TITF accepts ITF style or WT Kukkiwon style uniforms with TITF patch on left side over heart.

### **Age considerations**

- For those under 18 years of age, hand destructions are not permitted, with the exception of the front elbow strike or in some cases, at the discretion of the instructor and sitting examiners.

### **Patterns (Tuls):**

- The TITF allows its members to practice and examine with either the ITF or WT Kukkiwon Tul (patterns). With the ITF Tul the school owner can choose to use the sine wave motion if they wish or exclude it. As school owners you are permitted to set your own belt requirements. To achieve a higher rank you will need to complete requires as prescribed by your examiner.
- You will find both ITF and WT patterns to be mastered listed within appropriate dan level.

### **Destruction ...breaking boards:**

- Please abide by all local/domestic regulations in where these types of techniques are prohibited.
- In such situations in where they are prohibited are, please remove destruction techniques.

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Sources

## 1. Time requirements:

An average of two 1½ hour training sessions per week for 18 months since being promoted to 1st dan.

## 2. Stances:

- a. One leg stance (*waebal sogi*)
- b. Parallel stance heaven hand (*narani so hanulson*)
- c. Double stepping (*ibo omgyo didigi*)
- d. Double step turning (*ibo omgyo didimyo dolgi*)
- e. Foot shifting (*jajun bal*) - both feet

## 3. Defensive techniques:

- a. Double arc hand block (*doo bandal son makgi*)
- b. Forefist pressing block (*ap joomuk noollo makgi*)
- c. Inner forearm wedging block (*an palmok hechyo makgi*)
- d. Low front block (*najunde ap makgi*)
- e. Low reverse block (*najunde bandae makgi*)
- f. Nine (9) shape block (*gutja makgi*)
- g. Reverse knifehand low guarding block (*sonkal dung najunde daebi makgi*)
- h. Scooping block (*duro makgi*)
- i. U-shaped grasp (*digutja japgi*)

## 4. Offensive techniques:

- a. Back elbow thrust (*dwit palkup tulgi*)
- b. Backfist front strike (*dung joomuk ap taerigi*)
- c. Horizontal punch (*soopyong jirugi*)
- d. Middle knuckle fist punch (*joongji joomuk jirugi*)
- e. Sidefist downward strike (*yop joomuk naeryo taerigi*)
- f. Twin elbow horizontal thrust (*sang palkup soopyong tulgi*)
- g. Upset punch (*dwijibo jirugi*)
- h. Pressing kick (*noollo chagi*)

## 5. Ground techniques:

### Hand technique (*son gisoool*)

- a. Ground crosscut (*noowo ghutgi*)
- b. Ground punch (*noowo jirugi*)

- c. Ground strike (*noowo taerigi*)
- d. Ground thrust (*noowo tulgi*)
- e. Holding (*bachigi*)
- f. Checking (*momchugi*)
- g. Covering (*karioogi*)

**Foot technique (*bal gisool*)**

- a. Ground checking kick (*noowo cha momchugi*)
- b. Ground crescent kick (*noowo bandal chagi*)
- c. Ground hooking kick (*noowo golcho chagi*)
- d. Ground piercing kick (*noowo cha jirugi*)
- e. Ground smashing kick (*noowo cha busigi*)
- f. Ground thrusting kick (*noowo cha tulgi*)
- g. Ground dodging (*noowo pihagi*)
- h. Knee bending (*moorup guburigi*)
- i. Leg crossing (*dari kogi*)

- 6. Patterns: ITF:**
- a. Kwang-Gae Tul – 39 movements
  - b. Po-Eun Tul – 36 movements
  - c. Ge-Baek Tul – 44 movements

**WT Yudanja :** Koryo-Meaning Korea-30 movements

- 6. Sparring:**
- a. One step sparring (*ilbo matsogi*)  
Own choice of around 6 one step sparring techniques including dodging techniques. The attacker or the examiner determines the techniques that the attacker performs. Should demonstrate right and left sides equally. Candidate should also know all previous step sparring syllabi.
  - b. Free sparring (*jayu matsogi*)
- 8. Self defense:** On the ground (a pre-arranged partner is allowed)
- a. Breakfalling  
Be able to demonstrate basic breakfalling drills as well as showing proficiency in breakfalling throughout the grading.
  - b. Defending  
Defend against an opponent in a standing position, a ground mount position and in a ground T-position.
  - c. Disengaging  
Demonstrate the get-up and tactical disengagement in a realistic manner, alone as well as throughout the self-defense portion of the grading.

**9. Destruction:** Set by Examiner

**10. Fitness:** Set by Examiner

**11. Theory:** All theory contained within the Colored Belt Techniques Syllabus Handbook plus:

a. Pattern meanings

Meaning of Kwang-Gae

Kwang-Gae is named after the famous Kwang-Gae-Toh-Wang, the 19<sup>th</sup> King of the Koguryo Dynasty, who regained all the lost territories including the greater part of Manchuria. The diagram represents the expansion and recovery of lost territory. The 39 movements refer to the first two figures of 391 AD, the year he came to the throne.

Meaning of Po-Eun

Po-Eun is the pseudonym of a loyal subject Chong Mong-Chu (1400) who was a famous poet and whose poem “I would not serve a second master though I might be crucified a hundred times” is known to every Korean. He was also a pioneer in the field of physics. The diagram represents his unerring loyalty to the king and country towards the end of the Koryo Dynasty.

Meaning of Ge-Baek

Ge-Baek is named after Ge-Baek, a great general in the Baek Je Dynasty (660 AD). The diagram represents his severe and strict military discipline.



- b. Meaning of the Black Belt  
Opposite to white, therefore, signifying the maturity and proficiency in Taekwon-Do. It also indicates the wearer's imperviousness to darkness and fear.

c. Theory of Power

The beginning student may ask; "Where does one obtain the power to create the devastating results attributed to 'Taekwon- Do?'" This power is attributed to the utilisation of a person's full potential through the mathematical application of Taekwon-Do techniques. The average person uses only 10 to 20 percent of his potential. Anyone, regardless of size, age, or sex who can condition himself to use 100 percent of his potential can also perform the same destructive techniques. Though training will certainly result in a superb level of physical fitness, it will not necessarily result in the acquisition of extraordinary stamina or superhuman strength. More important, Taekwon-Do training will result in obtaining a high level of reaction force, concentration, equilibrium, breath control and speed; these are the factors that will result in a high degree of physical power.

Reaction Force (*bandong ryok*)

According to Newton's Law, every force has an equal and opposite force. When an automobile crashes into a wall with the force of 2,000 pounds, the wall will return a force of 2,000 pounds; or forcing the end of a seesaw down with a ton of weight will provide an upward force of the same weight; if your opponent is rushing towards you at a high speed, by the slightest blow at his head, the force with which you strike his head would be that of his own onslaught plus that of your blow. The two forces combined; his, which is large, and yours, which is small are quite impressive. This, then, is the reaction force from the opponent. Another reaction force is your own. A punch with the right fist is aided by pulling back the left fist to the hip.

Concentration (*jip joong*)

By applying the impact force onto the smallest target area, it will concentrate the force and therefore, increase its effect. For example, the force of water coming out of a water hose is greater if the outlet is smaller. Conversely, the weight of a man spread out on snow shoes makes hardly any impression on the snow. The blows in Taekwon-Do are often concentrated onto the edge of the open palm or to the crook of the fingers. It is very important that you should not unleash all your strength at the beginning but gradually, and particularly at the point of contact with your opponent's body, the force must be so concentrated as to give a knockout blow. That is to say, the shorter the time for the concentration, the greater will be the power of the blow. The utmost concentration is required in order to mobilize every muscle of the body onto the smallest target area simultaneously.

In conclusion, concentration is done in two ways: one is to concentrate every muscle of the body, particularly the bigger muscles around the hip and abdomen (which theoretically are slower than the smaller muscles of other parts of the body) towards the appropriate tool to be used at the proper time; the second way is to concentrate such mobilized muscles onto the opponent's vital spot. This is the reason why the hip and abdomen are jerked slightly before the hands and feet in any action, whether it be attack or defence.

Remember, jerking can be executed in two ways: laterally and vertically.

### Equilibrium (*kyun hyung*)

Balance is of utmost importance in any type of athletics. In Taekwon-Do, it deserves special consideration. By keeping the body always in equilibrium, that is, well balanced, a blow is more effective and deadly. Conversely, the unbalanced one is easily toppled. The stance should always be stable yet flexible, for both offensive and defensive movements.

Equilibrium is classified into both dynamic and static stability. They are so closely interrelated that the maximum force can only be produced when the static stability is maintained through dynamic stability.

To maintain good equilibrium, the centre of gravity of the stance must fall on a straight line midway between both legs when the body weight is distributed equally on both legs, or in the centre of the foot if it is necessary to concentrate the bulk of body weight on one foot. The centre of gravity can be adjusted according to body weight. Flexibility and knee spring are also important in maintaining balance for both a quick attack and instant recovery. One additional point; the heel of the rear foot should never be off the ground at the point of impact. This is not only necessary for good balance but also to produce maximum power at the point of impact.

### Speed (*sokdo*)

Speed is the most essential factor of force or power. Scientifically, force equals mass x acceleration ( $F = ma$ ) or ( $P = mV^2$ ).

According to the theory of kinetic energy, every object increases its weight as well as speed in a downward movement. This very principle is applied to this particular art of self-defence. For this reason, at the moment of impact, the position of the hand normally becomes lower than the shoulder and the foot lower than the hip while the body is in the air.

Reaction force, breath control, equilibrium, concentration and relaxation of the muscles cannot be ignored. However, these are the factors that contribute to the speed and all these factors, together with flexible and rhythmic movements, must be well coordinated to produce the maximum power in Taekwon-Do.

### Breath Control (*hohup jojul*)

Controlled breathing not only affects one's stamina and speed but can also condition a body to receive a blow and augment the power of a blow directed against an opponent. Through practice, breath stopped in the state of exhaling at the critical moment when a blow is landed against a pressure point on the body can prevent a loss of consciousness and stifle pain. A sharp exhaling of breath at the moment of impact and stopping the breath during the execution of a movement tense the abdomen to concentrate maximum effort on the delivery of the motion, while a slow inhaling helps the preparation of the next movement. An important rule to remember: Never inhale while focusing a block or blow against an opponent. Not only will this impede movement but it will also result in a loss of power.

Students should also practice disguised breathing to conceal any outward signs of fatigue. An experienced fighter will certainly press an attack when he realises his opponent is on the point of exhaustion.

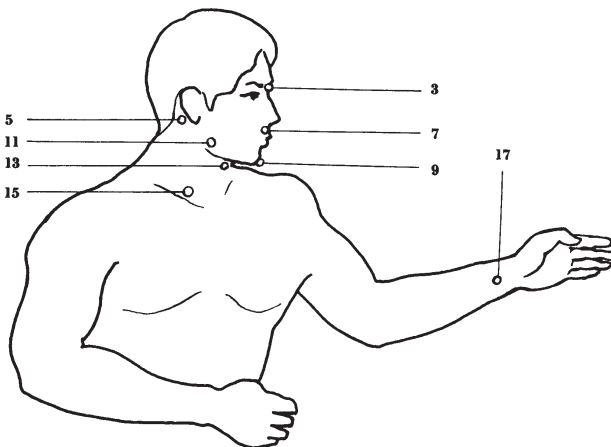
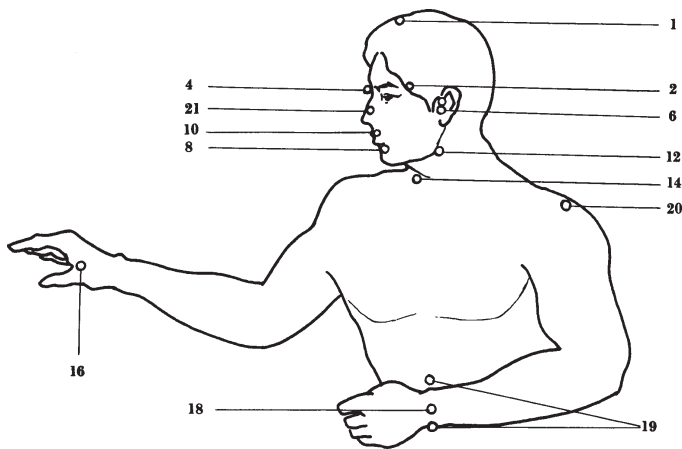
One breath is required for one movement with the exception of a connecting motion.

### Mass (*zilyang*)

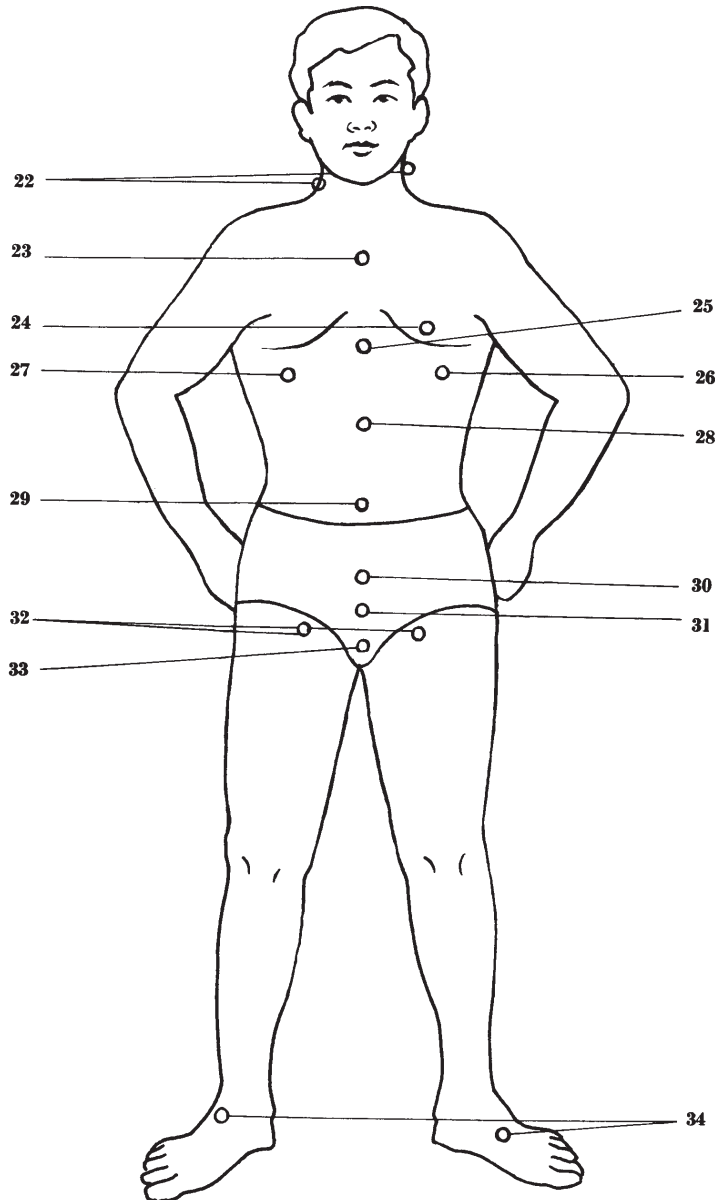
Mathematically, the maximum kinetic energy or force is obtained from maximum body weight and speed and it is all important that the body weight be increased during the execution of a blow. No doubt the maximum body weight is applied with the motion by turning the hip. The large abdominal muscles are twisted to provide additional body momentum. Thus the hip rotates in the same direction as that of the attacking or blocking tool. Another way of increasing body weight is the utilisation of a springing action of the knee joint. This is achieved by slightly raising the hip at the beginning of the motion and lowering the hip at the moment of impact to drop the body weight into the motion.

d. Vital spots

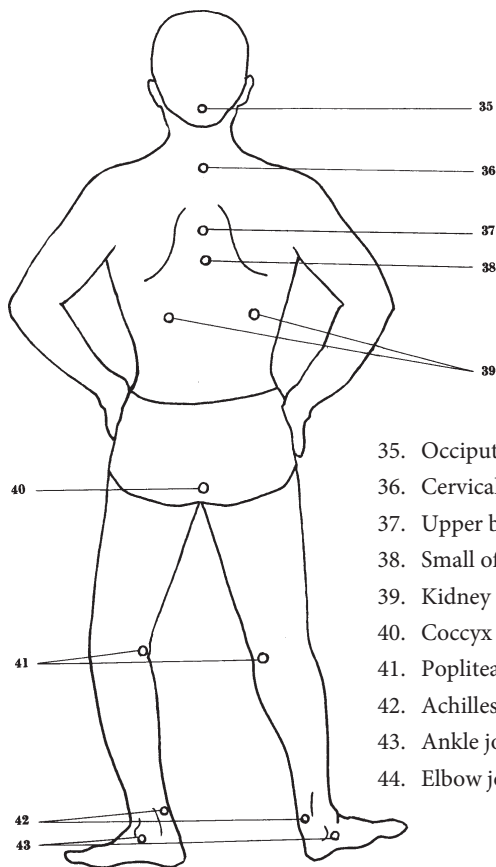
A vital spot in Taekwon-Do is defined as any sensitive or breakable area on the body vulnerable to an attack. It is essential that a student of Taekwon-Do has a knowledge of the different spots so that he can use the proper attacking or blocking tool. Indiscriminate attack is to be condemned as it is inefficient and wasteful of energy.



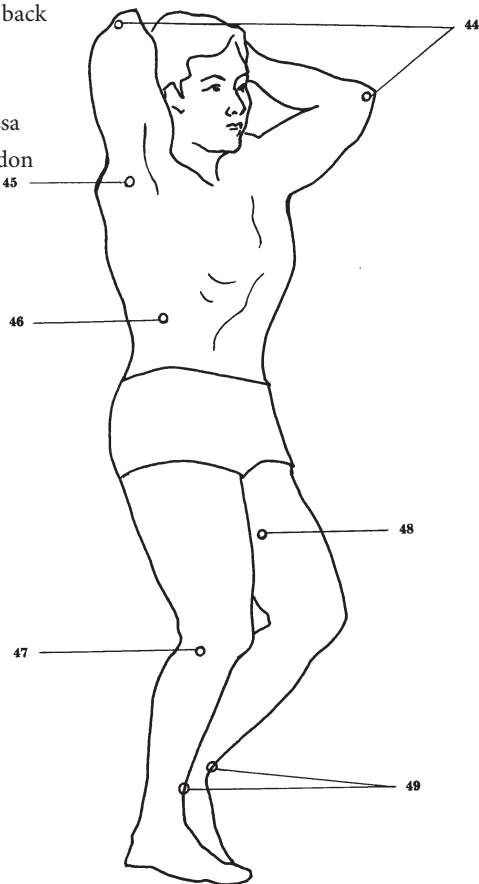
1. Skull
2. Temple
3. Bridge of the nose
4. Eyeball
5. Mastoid
6. Mandibular nerve
7. Philtrum
8. Jaw
9. Point of the chin
10. Lips
11. Angle of the mandible
12. Upper neck
13. Adam's apple
14. Windpipe
15. Clavicle
16. Thenar eminence
17. Radial artery
18. Back wrist artery
19. Wrist joint
20. Shoulder joint
21. Nose



- 22. Neck artery
- 23. Sternum
- 24. Heart
- 25. Epigastrium
- 26. Spleen
- 27. Liver
- 28. Solar plexus
- 29. Umbilicus
- 30. Lower abdomen
- 31. Pubic region
- 32. Groin
- 33. Scrotum
- 34. Instep



- 35. Occiput
- 36. Cervical spine
- 37. Upper back
- 38. Small of the back
- 39. Kidney
- 40. Coccyx
- 41. Popliteal fossa
- 42. Achilles tendon
- 43. Ankle joint



- 45. Armpit
- 46. Floating ribs
- 47. Knee joint
- 48. Inner thigh
- 49. Tibia

e. Stances

The forceful and finer techniques of attack and defence are largely dependent on a correct stance since the stance is the starting point of every Taekwon-Do movement. Stability, agility, balance and flexibility are the controlling factors.

Basic principles for a proper stance are:

1. Keep the back straight, with few exceptions.
2. Relax the shoulders.
3. Tense the abdomen.
4. Maintain a correct facing. The stance may be full facing, half facing or side facing the opponent.
5. Maintain equilibrium.
6. Make use of the knee spring properly.

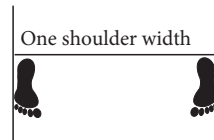
**Close stance** (*moa sogi*)

- full facing or side facing
- body weight even on both feet



**Parallel stance** (*narani sogi*)

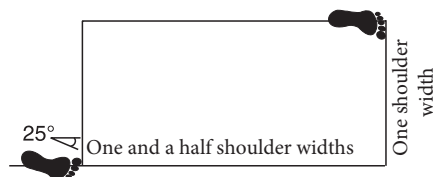
- full facing or side facing
- body weight even on both feet



**Walking stance** (*gunnun sogi*)

This is a strong stance for front and rear, both in attack and defence.

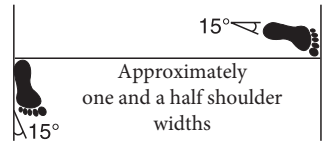
- full facing or half facing
- body weight even on both feet
- when the right leg is in the front it is a right stance, and vice versa
- bend the front leg until the knee cap forms a vertical line with the heel, extending the opposite leg fully
- tense the muscles of the feet with the feeling of pulling them toward each other



### **L-stance** (*niunja sogi*)

This is widely used for defence, though used in attack as well. The front foot is readily available for kicking with a slight shift of the body weight and with the advantage of half facing as well as body shifting.

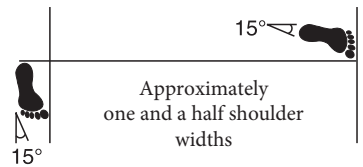
- Move one foot to the either the front or rear a distance of 1.5 shoulder widths from the footsword of the rear foot to the toes of the front foot, almost forming a right angle
- The toes of both feet point 15 degrees inward
- Place the heel of the front foot 2.5cm beyond the heel of the rear foot.
- always half facing
- about 70 percent body weight on the rear leg and 30 percent on the front leg
- when the right leg is in the rear it is a right stance, and vice versa
- bend the rear leg until the knee cap forms a vertical line with the toes, bending the front leg proportionally



### **Fixed stance** (*gojung sogi*)

It is an effective stance for attack and defence to the side.

- Move one foot to the either the front or rear a distance of 1.5 shoulder widths from the big toe of the rear foot to the toes of the front foot, almost forming a right angle
- always half facing
- body weight even on both feet
- when the right leg is in the front it is a right stance, and vice versa



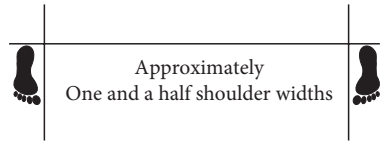
### **Sitting stance** (*annun sogi*)

This is a very stable stance for lateral movement. It is also widely used for punching exercise and muscle development of the legs. One of the advantages of this stance is to shift into walking stance without relocating the foot.

- full facing or side facing
- body weight even on both feet
- extend the knees outward, bending until the knee caps come over the ball of the foot



- infuse the strength into the inner thighs and tense inward by scraping the ground or floor with the side soles

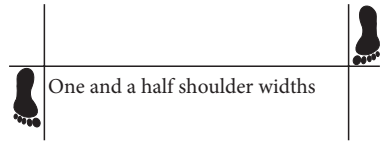


- push both the chest and abdomen out and pull the hip back tensing the abdomen

### Diagonal stance (*sasun sogi*)

This is very useful for shifting into a walking stance without relocating the foot. It is used for attacking or defending against the front or rear.

- full facing or side facing
- body weight even on both feet
- when the right leg is in the front it is a right stance, and vice versa



### X-stance (*kyocha sogi*)

This is a very convenient stance, in particular for attacking the side or front in a jumping motion. It is frequently used for blocking and serves as a preparatory stance for moving into the next manoeuvre.

- full, side or half facing
- body weight on the stationary foot
- when the weight is rested on the right foot it is a right stance, and vice versa
- cross one foot over or behind the other, touching the ground slightly with the ball of the foot
- one foot always crosses over the front of the other with the exception of a jumping motion



Stepping



Jumping

### One-leg stance (*waebal sogi*)

Though this stance is primarily used for balance exercise, it is occasionally utilised in attack and defence techniques. Stretch the stationary leg and bring the other reverse footword on the knee joint or instep to the hollow.

- full facing or side facing
- body weight on the stationary foot
- when standing with the right foot it is a right stance, and vice versa

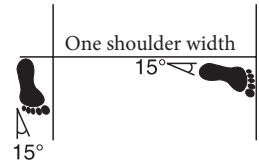
### **Bending stance** (*guburyo sogi*)

This serves as a preparatory stance for side and back kicks, though it is frequently used for defence techniques.

- full facing or half facing
- body weight on the stationary foot
- when standing with the right foot it is a right stance, and vice versa

### **Vertical stance** (*soojik sogi*)

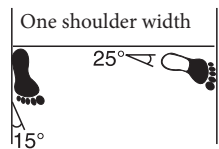
- always half facing
- 60 percent body weight on the rear leg and 40 percent on the front leg
- when the right leg is in the rear it is a right stance, and vice versa
- keep the legs straight



### **Rear foot stance** (*dwitbal sogi*)

This is used for defence and occasionally for attack. The advantage of this stance is the ability to kick or adjust the distance from an opponent with the front foot which can move spontaneously without any additional shifting of the body weight to the rear foot.

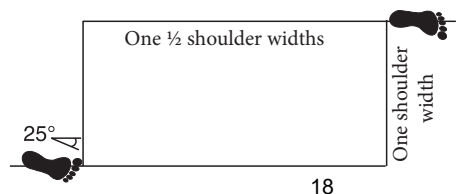
- always half facing
- body weight mostly on the rear foot
- when the right leg is in the rear it is a right stance, and vice versa
- bend the rear leg until the knee comes over the toes, placing the heel slightly beyond the heel of the front foot
- bend the front leg, touching the ground slightly with the ball of the foot
- be sure to keep the knee of the rear leg pointing slightly inward



### **Low stance** (*nachuo sogi*)

The advantage of this stance is the ease with which one can extend the attacking tool. It can also develop the leg muscles and is effective to adjust the distance to and from the target.

- full facing or half facing
- body weight even on both feet
- when the right leg is in the front it is a right stance, and vice versa



**Ready stance (*junbi sogi*)**

Though there are many ready stances, parallel, walking, sitting, L-, X, close and bending ready stances are exclusively used in the fundamental and pattern exercises. The ready stance is not a direct part of any action. It merely positions a student before he begins his motions or allows time for concentration of spirit.

**Attention stance (*charyot sogi*)**

This is an attention position used before and after each exercise.

- feet form a 45 degree angle
- drop the fists down naturally, bending the elbows slightly
- the fists are clenched slightly
- eyes face the front slightly above the horizontal line

**Bow posture (*kyong ye jase*)**

- bend the body 15 degrees forward
- keep eyes fixed on opponent's eyes

**WT Yudanja pattern Meaning:****KORYO**

Koryo poomsae symbolizes “seonbae”, which means a learned man, who is characterized by a strong martial spirit as well as a righteous learned man’s spirit. The spirit had been inherited through the ages of Koguryo, Palhae and down to Koryo (Korea is the name of an old Korean Dynasty), which is the background of organizing the Koryo poomsae. The line of poomsae represents the Chinese letter which means “seonbae” or “seonbi”, a learned man or a man of virtue in the Korean language.

## 1. Time requirements:

An average of two 1½ hour training sessions per week for 2 years since being promoted to 2nd dan.

## 2. Stances:

- a. Diagonal stance (*sasun sogi*)
- b. Close ready stance D (*moa junbi sogi D*)
- c. Parallel stance with a twin side elbow (*narani so sang yop palkup*)
- d. Close stance heaven hand (*moa so hanulson*)
- e. Bending ready stance B (*goburyo junbi sogi B*)

## 3. Defensive techniques:

- a. Alternate palm downward block (*euhkallin sonbadak naeryo makgi*)
- b. Downward block (*naeryo makgi*)
- c. Knifehand rising block (*sonkal chookyo makgi*)
- d. Low inward block (*najunde anuro makgi*)
- e. Parallel block (*narani makgi*)
- f. Reverse knifehand circular block (*sonkal dung dollimyo makgi*)
- g. Twin palm pressing block (*sang sonbadak noollo makgi*)
- h. Twin palm rising block (*sang sonbadak chookyo makgi*)
- i. X-fist downward block (*kyocha joomuk naeryo makgi*)

## 4. Offensive techniques:

- a. Downward punch (*naeryo jirugi*)
- b. Crescent punch (*bandal jirugi*)
- c. Turning punch (*dollyo jirugi*)
- d. Double finger thrust (*doo songarak tulgi*)
- e. Backhand downward strike (*sondung naeryo taerigi*)
- f. Backfist side front strike (*dung joomuk yobap taerigi*)
- g. Twin knifehand horizontal strike (*sang sonkal soopyong taerigi*)
- h. Arc hand strike (*bandal son taerigi*)
- i. Twin foreknuckle fist crescent punch (*sang inji joomuk bandal jirugi*)
- j. Open fist punch (*pyon joomuk jirugi*)
- k. Crosscut (*ghutgi*)

- l. High elbow strike (*nopunde palkup taerigi*)
- m. Mid-air strike (*twio dolmyo taerigi*)
- n. Straight elbow downward thrust (*sun palkup naeryo tulgi*)
- o. Arc hand crescent strike (*bandal son bandal taerigi*)
- p. Twin knifehand inward strike (*sang sonkal anuro taerigi*)
- q. Backfist horizontal strike (*dung joomuk soopyong taerigi*)
- r. Flying consecutive punch (*twimyo yonsok jirugi*)
- s. Knee front snap kick (*moorup apcha busigi*)
- t. Dodging reverse turning kick (*pihamyo bandae dollyo chagi*)
- u. Two direction kick - side twisting, front back (*sangbang chagi - yop bituro chagi, ap dwi chagi*)
- v. Stamping kick (*cha bapgi*)
- w. Straight kick (*jigaeu chagi*)

5. **Patterns:** ITF: a. Eui-Am Tul – 45 movements  
 b. Choong-Jang Tul – 52 movements  
 c. Juche Tul- 45 movements or Ko-Dang Tul- 39 movements

**WT Yudanja :** Keumgang-Meaning Daimond-27 movements

6. **Sparring:** a. One step sparring (*ilbo matsogi*)  
 Own choice of around 6 one step sparring techniques including flying double kicks, flying consecutive kicks and flying combination kicks. The attacker or the examiner determines the techniques that the attacker performs. Should demonstrate right and left sides equally. Candidate should also know all previous step sparring syllabi.
- b. Pre-arranged free sparring (*yaksok jayu matsogi*)  
 At least 2 routines with attacker of own choice. A pre-arranged partner is allowed. Approximately 1 minute total in duration.
- c. Free sparring (*jayu matsogi*)  
 With partners of own rank and with more senior black belts, plus two onto one free sparring

7. **Self defense:** Against weapon attack  
 Non pre-arranged defence against a stick attack. A pre-arranged partner is allowed. Approximately 1½ minutes in duration.

8. **Destruction:** Set by Examiner
9. **Fitness:** Set by Examiner
10. **Theory:** All theory contained within the Colored Belt Techniques Syllabus Handbook, general knowledge of Taekwon-Do, plus:

a. Pattern meanings

Meaning of Eui-Am

Eui-Am is the pseudonym of Son Byong Hi, leader of the Korean independence movement on March 1, 1919. The 45 movements refer to his age when he changed the name of Dong Hak (Oriental Culture) to Chondo Kyo (Heavenly Way Religion) in 1905. The diagram represents his indomitable spirit, displayed while dedicating himself to the prosperity of his nation.

Meaning of Choong-Jang

Choong-Jang is the pseudonym given to General Kim Duk Ryang who lived during the Lee Dynasty, 14th century. This pattern ends with a left-hand attack to symbolize the tragedy of his death at 27 in prison before he was able to reach full maturity.

Meaning of Juche

Juche is a philosophical idea that man is the master of everything and decides everything, in other words, the idea that man is the master of the world and his own destiny. It is said that this idea was rooted in Baekdu Mountain which symbolizes the spirit of the Korean people. The diagram ( ) represent Baekdu Mountain.

Meaning of Ko-Dang

Ko-Dang is the pseudonym of the patriot Cho Man-Sik, who dedicated his life to the Korean Independence Movement and to the education of his people. The 39 movements signify his times of imprisonment and his birthplace on the 39th parallel.

b. System of rank (*dan gup jedo*)

In Taekwon-Do, character development, fortitude, tenacity, and technique are graded as well as individual capacity. The promotional scale is divided into nineteen ranks - 10 grades (*gup*) and nine degrees (*dan*). The former begins with 10th grade (*gup*) the lowest and ends at first grade. Degrees begin with the first degree (*dan*) and end with the ultimate, ninth degree.

There is, of course, a certain significance in the numbering system. With degree, the number 9 is not only the highest one among one digit numbers but also is the number of 3 multiplied by 3. In the Orient, three is the most esteemed of all the numbers. The Chinese character representing three is written: 三. The upper line symbolizes the heaven; the middle line, mortals; and the bottom line, earth.

It was believed that the individual who was successful in promoting his country, fellowmen and God, and able to reach an accord with all three would aspire to become King, which was written thusly The Chinese character for three and King are nearly synonymous. When the number three is multiplied by itself, the equation is nine, the highest of the high; therefore, ninth degree is the highest of the high ranking belts.

Taking the use of the number three one step further, the degrees are further divided into three distinct classes. First through third degree is considered the novice stages of black belt. Students are still merely beginners in comparison to the higher degrees. At fourth degree, the student crosses the threshold of puberty and enters the expert class. Seventh through ninth is composed of Taekwon-Do masters - the elite who fully understand all the particulars of Taekwon-Do, mental and physical.

There is perhaps one question that remains; why begin with the lowest of the two digit numbers, "10" why not begin with the lowest one digit number and proceed from first grade to ninth grade, and then begin again for degrees? Though it would certainly be more logical, the 10 to 1 and 1 to 10 numerical system in the Orient is ageless.

It would be impossible, if not even a bit impertinent, to attempt to change a practice that is even carried into children's games.

c. Composition of Taekwon-Do (*Taekwon-Do goosung*)

Taekwon-Do is composed of fundamental movements, patterns, *dallyon*, sparring and self-defence techniques that are so closely related that it is impossible to segregate one phase of instruction from another.

Fundamental movements are necessary for sparring and patterns, while both patterns and sparring are indispensable for perfection of fundamental movements.

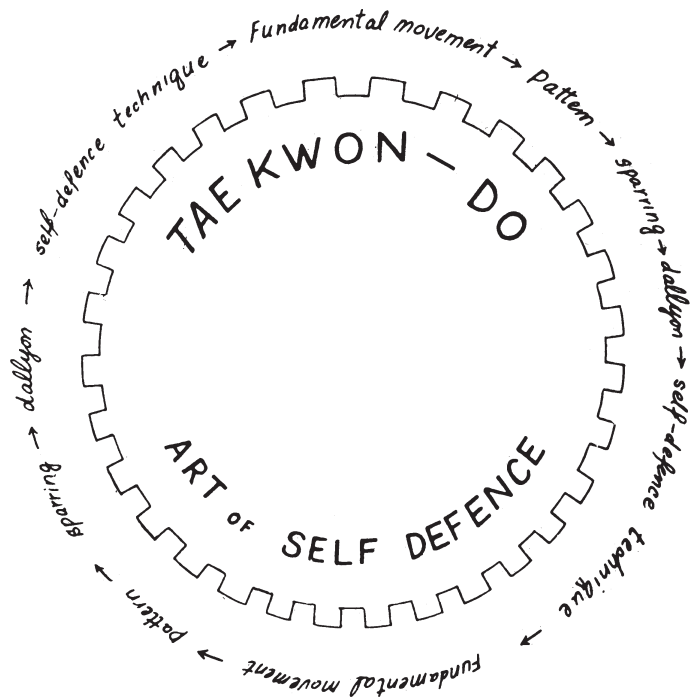
Each fundamental movement, in most cases, represents an attack or defence against a particular target area or definite action of an imaginary opponent or opponents. It is necessary to learn as many fundamental

movements as possible and fit them into complete proficiency so the student can meet any situation in actual combat with confidence. The pattern actually places the student in a hypothetical situation where he must avail himself to defence, counter-attack, and attack motions, against several opponents.

Through constant practice of these patterns, the attack and defence become a conditioned reflex movement. Power and speed must be developed to such a high degree that only one single blow is needed to stop an opponent, so the student can shift stance and block or attack another opponent. Each pattern is different from the other in order to develop reaction against changing circumstances.

Once the basic patterns are mastered, the student then begins to physically apply the skill obtained from fundamental movements and patterns to sparring against actual moving opponents.

Collaterally with sparring, the student must begin to develop his body and toughen his attacking and blocking tools so he is able to deliver maximum damage in actual combat (*dallyon*). Once a student has applied himself to fundamental movements, patterns, sparring, and *dallyon*, then the time has arrived for the student to test his coordination, speed, balance, and concentration against spontaneous attacks; ie self-defence. The student will constantly find himself returning, however, to his fundamentals even when he has achieved the highest possible degree of proficiency in self-defence techniques.





As in military training, Taekwon-Do progression follows a certain parallel:

1. Fundamental movements = Individual soldier's basic training
2. Dallyon = Maintenance of equipment
3. Patterns = Platoon tactics
4. Sparring = Field exercises in simulated combat conditions
5. Self-defence = Actual combat

d. Hand, foot & miscellaneous parts

**Hand parts** (*sang bansin*):

|                           |                   |                    |
|---------------------------|-------------------|--------------------|
| angle fingertip           | arc-hand          | back elbow back    |
| back fist                 | back forearm      | hand               |
| base of knife hand double | bear hand finger  | bow wrist          |
| fingertip                 | belly fore-       | finger pincers     |
| flat fingertip forefinger | knuckle fist      | forearm            |
| inner forearm             | forefist          | front elbow        |
| middle knuckle fist palm  | knife-hand open   | long fist          |
| side elbow                | fist press finger | outer forearm      |
| straight fingertip thumb  | side fist thumb   | reverse knife-hand |
| ridge                     | under fist upset  | straight elbow     |
| upper elbow               | fingertip         | thumb knuckle fist |
|                           |                   | under forearm      |

**Foot parts** (*ha bansin*):

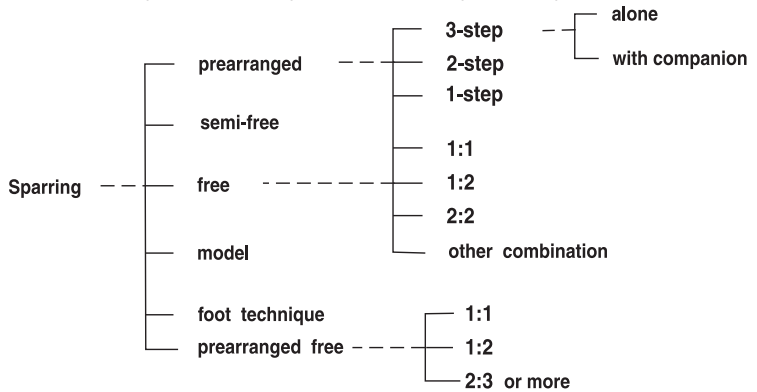
|                        |             |                       |
|------------------------|-------------|-----------------------|
| back heel              |             |                       |
| footsword              |             |                       |
| reverse footsword toes | back sole   | ball of the foot knee |
|                        | instep      | side sole             |
|                        | side instep |                       |
|                        | twin foot   |                       |

**Miscellaneous parts** (*gita boowi*):

|            |            |             |
|------------|------------|-------------|
| a          | back tibia | forehead    |
| nkle joint | inner      | inner tibia |
| head       | ankle      | outer tibia |
| occiput    | joint      | tibia       |
| shin       | outer      |             |
| toe edge   | ankle      |             |
|            | joint      |             |
|            | shoulder   |             |

e. System of sparring (*matsogi goosong*)

Sparring is classified into prearranged, semi-free, free, foot technique model and prearranged free sparring with the following sub-categories.



Sparring is the physical application of attack and defence techniques gained from pattern and fundamental exercise against actual moving opponent or opponents under various situations. It is, therefore, not only indispensable to promote the fighting spirit and courage, to train the eyes, to read the opponent's tactic as well as manoeuvres, to forge, toughen or develop the attacking and blocking tools, to test his own skills and ability, to learn other movements hardly to be gained from pattern or fundamental exercise.

**General information on prearranged sparring**

It is practised as the name denotes under prearranged modes with various assumptions, for example the number of steps to be taken, the target to be attacked and the attacking tool to be used are agreed upon beforehand between the players.

Basic principles:

- both players (X and Y) stand at a full length distance apart of the stance to be taken for attack, from the front half of the opponent's foot, facing each other
- bow to each other before and after each exercise
- gaze at the opponent's eyes at all times
- attack and defence are conducted alternately between X and Y in most cases
- block should be executed just before the attacking tool reaches the vital spot with an appropriate blocking tool
- dodge must be made to such a distance as to enable the counter attack to be conducted easily in one motion

- counter-attack should be executed immediately after the last defence
- apply only those techniques learned from either pattern or fundamental exercise
- exercise right (attack and defence) and left (attack and defence) equally
- counter-attack should be limited to one time only

**11. Essay:** An original essay on any Taekwon-Do topic. Length at least 2000 words.  
Please supply on disk or by email as well as hard copy.

### **WT Yudanja pattern Meaning:**

#### **KEUMGANG**

Keumgang (meaning diamond) has the significance of “hardness” and “ponderosity”. The Mt. Keumgang on the Korean peninsula, which is regarded as the centre of national spirit, and the “Keumgang yoksa” (Kumgang warrior) as named by Buddha, who represents a mightiest warrior, are the background of denominating this poomsae. The poomsae line symbolizes a mountain displayed by the Chinese letter. The movements should be powerful and well-balanced so as to befit black-belter’s dignity.

## 1. Time and age requirements:

An average of two 1½ hour training sessions per week for 3 years since being promoted to 3rd dan. Minimum age to grade to 4th dan is 21 years old at the grading date.

## 2. Stances: a. Warrior ready stance B (*moosa junbi sogi B*)

## 3. Defensive techniques:

- a. Foot lifting (*bal dulgi*)
- b. Body dropping (*mom nachugi*)
- c. High outward block and forearm low block (*nopunde bakuro makgi wa palmok najunde makgi*)
- d. Reverse knifehand guarding block (*sonkal dung daebi makgi*)
- e. X-knifehand rising block (*kyocha sonkal chookyo makgi*)
- f. W-shape block (two targets) (*san makgi*)
- g. Waving kick (*doro chagi*)

## 4. Offensive techniques:

- a. Double fist low punch (*doo joomuk najunde jirugi*)
- b. U-shaped punch (*digutja jirugi*)
- c. Backhand horizontal strike (*sondung soopyong taerigi*)
- d. Middle knuckle fist punch (*joongji joomuk jirugi*)
- e. Sweeping kick (*suroh chagi*)
- f. Foot tackling (*bal golgi*)
- g. Grasping kick (*butjapgo chagi*)
- h. Punching kick (*jirumyo chagi*)
- i. Striking kick (*taerimyo chagi*)
- j. Thrusting kick (*tulumyo chagi*)

## 5. Patterns: ITF:

- a. Sam-il Tul – 33 movements
- b. Yoo-Sin Tul – 68 movements
- c. Choi-Yong Tul – 46 movements

**WT Yudanja :** Taebaek-Meaning Great White-26 movements

6. **Sparring:** a. Model sparring (*mobum matsogi*)  
Five routines. A pre-arranged partner is allowed.  
Candidate should also know all previous step sparring syllabi.
- b. Free sparring (*jayu matsogi*)  
With partners of own rank and with more senior black belts, plus two onto one free sparring
7. **Self defense:** Multiple Attackers  
Non pre-arranged defence against multiple opponents.  
Approximately 1½ minutes in duration. Pre-arranged partners are allowed.
8. **Destruction:** Set by Examiner
9. **Fitness:** Set by Examiner
10. **Theory:** All theory contained within the Colored Belt Techniques Syllabus Handbook, general knowledge of Taekwon-Do, plus:
- a. Pattern meanings

Meaning of Sam-il

Sam-il denotes the historical date of the independence movement of Korea which began throughout the country on March 1, 1919. The 33 movements in the pattern stand for the 33 patriots who planned the movement.

Meaning of Yoo-Sin

Yoo-Sin is named after General Kim Yoo Sin, a commanding general during the Silla Dynasty. The 68 movements refer to the last two figures of 668 AD, the year Korea was united. The ready posture signifies a sword drawn on the right rather than left side, symbolizing Yoo Sin's mistake of following his king's orders to fight with foreign forces against his own nation.

### Meaning of Choi-Yong

Choi-Yong is named after General Choi Yong, Premier and Commander-in-Chief of the Armed Forces during the 14th century Koryo Dynasty. Choi Yong was greatly respected for his loyalty, patriotism, and humility. He was executed by his subordinate commanders headed by General Yi Sung Gae, who later became the first king of the Lee Dynasty.

#### b. Training Secrets of Taekwon-Do

1. To study the theory of power thoroughly.
2. To understand the purpose and method of each movement clearly.
3. To bring the movement of eyes, hands, feet and breath into a single coordinated action.
4. To choose the appropriate attacking tool for each vital spot.
5. To become familiar with the correct angle and distance for attack and defence.
6. Keep both the arms and legs bent slightly while the movement is in motion.
7. All movements must begin with a backward motion with very few exceptions. However, once the movement is in motion it should not be stopped before reaching the target.
8. To create a sine wave during the movement by utilizing the knee spring properly.
9. To exhale briefly at the moment of each blow except a connecting motion.

#### c. Moral Culture (*jungshin sooyang*)

The broad connotations and various possible interpretations of the moral culture are often very difficult for the western mind to grasp because this is an aspect of Oriental Philosophy which pervades the lives of Oriental people. In a word, it is the endeavour and process of becoming an exemplary person such as Confucius (552-479 BC). To become such a person, one has to first find himself and acquire a moral character which is respected by all. This can only be achieved through constant practice of mental discipline. Thus, if the times call for it, the mentally disciplined man can contribute to the building of an ideal society through wise counsel to the government and, even after death, through his everlasting examples.

Confucius said "To promote the sense of morality one must treat others with faithfulness and sincerity based on righteousness, and to eliminate completely vicious thinking".

## I

Every one of us, as a social being, desires to live in a free and peaceful society. At the same time, it is our obligation to build such society for the people.

I have quoted various words of wisdom of ancient saints and philosophers for creating an ideal society in the hope that students of Taekwon-Do use them as a guide to cultivating their moral culture.

An ideal society, according to Lao-Tzu, is one in which the ruler is of such high moral character that he can rule naturally, not by interference or fear but by appealing to the good nature of his people, who by merely doing their duty can live freely in peace without fear and anxiety.

Next, a moral society is one in which the people admire and praise their ruler in gratitude for his love and the benign disposition he bears toward his people.

Thirdly there is a "legalistic society" in which the ruler because he lacks the moral authority resorts to various laws to govern his people, who in turn obey because they fear the retribution that the violation of these laws will bring. Under these circumstances, the ruler loses close touch with his people.

Finally the worst kind of society is that in which the ruler, through deception and trickery, misuses his legal authority to further his personal ambitions and imposes his rule upon his people by force as he deems necessary. In such a society, the ruler is despised and hated by his people and eventually invites not only his own downfall but with him the downfall of the people and the country.

In Taekwon-Do a heavy emphasis is placed on moral culture, for it not only promotes a healthy body and keen mind but good sportsmanship and the perfection of moral behaviour. As ancient Greeks first espoused in their sound mind, sound body, creative spirit concept, the more disciplined and cultivated the mind is, the more disciplined and cultivated will be the student's use of Taekwon-Do.

No doubt the following lessons may be somewhat hard to fully understand; however, it would behove the serious student of Taekwon-Do to read, digest, and attempt to grasp these very fundamental essences of moral culture.

### A. Return to the basic nature

Mencius gave the following analogy when he reasoned that a man is basically good.

Even a ruthless robber, coming upon an innocent child about to fall into a well, will try to save the child, forgetting for the moment, his intention to rob the house. This good nature becomes obscured or completely lost by greed for money and power.

## B. Be virtuous

It is difficult to define what virtue is. However, these are five human qualities which have been recognized as virtues since ancient times; humanity, righteousness, courtesy, wisdom, and trust. To be virtuous one must constantly cultivate and practice these virtues.

Confucius said:

“Virtue is like the north star. All the stars revolve around it in an orderly fashion”. Therefore, people who surround the virtuous person, naturally will act for the betterment of society.

### 1. Humanity (*in*)

The ability to feel sorrow for the misfortunes of fellow men and love them all equally as parents love their children equally.

Confucius defined humanity in the following ways:

- a. To love people, especially one's parents.
- b. Not asking others to do what you would rather not do.
- c. To behave automatically with the nature of propriety by promoting moral sense.
- d. To have unbending desire to accomplish what is right regardless of how insignificant the result may initially seem when compared to the amount of effort put forth.
- e. To value others' honour before your own.
- f. To put others' freedom before your own.

To implement humanity he said one should:

1. Practice utmost prudence, modesty and discretion in everyday life.
2. Devote oneself to assigned work be it large or small.
3. Demonstrate sincerity with whole heartedness to others at all times.

Tae Kong Mang (12th century BC) said:

“The heaven provides four seasons while the earth has the power to produce all living things. This privilege is not reserved for any specific person but for all human beings...therefore, humanity lies in the idea of sharing the fruits of nature with all people.”

### 2. Righteousness (*ui*)

The ability to feel ashamed of unjust acts and to do one's duty to others.

Mencius said; “for the ordinary person life and death are the most important in the life. However, for the virtuous person to live and die for righteousness is far more important than life and death themselves.”

Righteousness is well defined in the act of a certain army general depicted in the book of “War Manual” written about 2,400 years ago.



A General was taking a break from the gruelling war with his soldiers by a river bank when an aide brought him a small carafe of wine for his refreshment. He took the carafe and slowly emptied it into the flowing river in full view of the puzzled soldiers and invited them to share the wine with him by taking a sip of the water from the river.

As to righteousness;

Manfucius claimed it to be the fundamental virtue to be observed by a human being. According to Soonja, "It is the essential element along with the propriety (*ye*) for moral education."

Confucius said, "It is the supportive measure employed to enhance humanity thought to be the highest degree of virtue."

### 3. Propriety (*ye*)

Unlike animals fighting over food, a courteous man would offer another man a piece of bread even though both were starving, out of respect and good manners.

Confucius said, "Propriety must be practised for the proper development of personality, and whoever lacks sincerity in his words, cannot be considered a gentleman."

He also said:

"Honesty without courtesy can be rather ruthless."

"Respectfulness without courtesy can make the recipient rather uncomfortable."

"Courageousness without courtesy can be rather violent."

"Prudence without courtesy can be rather cowardish."

Ye is a term describing proper code of conduct between various social status, for example: superior and inferior, noble and common, old and young, rich and poor, etc.

### 4. Wisdom (*ji*)

The ability to judge right from wrong, not especially in matters concerning the right and wrong of others but in matters concerning oneself.

A wise man (Yu Bee) once said to his sons, "No matter how small it is you should not do what you realise is wrong. On the other hand you must do what is right no matter how small it may seem."

### 5. Trust (*shin*)

The ability to keep one's words and promises, not only to one's friends but to everyone in general. Without trust a person loses all principles and dignities and becomes a liar and a cheater.

## II

How, then, can man discover his own human nature?

There are two ways by which a person can find himself; first, by preserving the goodness given to him by God or heaven at birth, and secondly by renouncing greed for material things.

### A. Man may occupy two positions in a life time

Basically there are two kinds of position; one is the five virtues given by heaven, explained earlier, and the other given by man, such as a cabinet minister, bureau chief, and so on.

Unfortunately man often relies too much on worldly position which is transient at best, for what man gives can also be taken away. On the other hand, what heaven endows us with is eternal. This is not to say that we reject all worldly things but rather that we keep both positions in proper balance so that the virtues of the former position provides guidance for the proper use of the latter.

In this manner a man will gain respect and set good examples for others to follow. Without proper guidance, a person can easily fall victim to the temptations of personal power and wealth, employing unethical means to further his ambitions. Ultimately such a person will become a tyrant, or a dictator and an enemy of the people.

According to Confucius, a generous and loving man cannot have enemies. Therefore, humanity, the first virtue, is like a strong secure fortress.

### B. Greed is insatiable

He who is content with what he has is the richest man in the world. On the other hand, if one has everything and still desires more, he may yet be poor. A man who is blinded by greed is not only given to corruption, intrigue and exploitation of others, but worst of all, he casts himself in the position of "friend fighting against friend, father fighting against son", finally becoming no better than an animal.

There is certain truth in the old saying that a truly good person cannot be rich, and rich person cannot be a truly good person.

According to an ancient adage, "Constant material dissatisfaction is considered to be the root of all misfortunes." There is no better way to self-satisfaction and human growth than the constant development of a generous nature.

### C. Be humble

A weed holds up its head in arrogance while a mature grain bows its head in humility. Lao-Tzu taught that lofty virtue is like a deep valley into which all streams of water flow. A virtuous man will draw the respect

of others toward him in the same fashion while one who is selfish and egoistic will lose the respect of his fellow man and become despised and isolated.

To be humble is not to engage in petty squabbles, but to be like the magnanimous river in the low valley which irrigates the farm fields around it.

#### D. Self-criticism

No one is wise from the moment of birth. As human beings we have many faults and are prone to make mistakes. However, once having acquired knowledge we learn to correct these shortcomings.

It would not be impossible to eventually become perfect human beings. For this purpose, it is essential not be idyllic towards learning and continue to be willing to criticise oneself.

It is said that Confucius and his pupils practised self-criticism by repeating the following three times daily:

1. Have I neglected others' requests because of selfishness
2. Have I behaved with a sincere attitude towards friends
3. Have I inspired others with certainty, while being uncertain myself
4. Have I neglected to practise virtue
5. Have I erred in my studies
6. Have I avoided acting with righteousness
7. Have I corrected myself immediately upon realising my fault

#### E. Be soft

Because light is formless and soft, it can illuminate and give warmth to even hidden corners. As water can assume any shape or form, it can better serve the living things that need it to survive. Once water becomes a part of the Ocean, even the largest ship is like a mere leaf, and its awesome fury when aroused can conquer the tallest mountain.

If one claims to be strong, he will soon meet someone who is stronger. A tree, such as sapling, can withstand a strong wind when it is soft and flexible but may be toppled or broken after it becomes old and brittle. The same principle also applies to human beings.

#### F. Respect of elders

As son respects parents, younger brother respects older brother, man must always respect his elders or seniors. This is the beauty of mankind, and one of the distinctions between human and animal.

Mencius said there are three things of value in human society; position, age and moral integrity. In government, position is considered important, in a community, age, and for a leader or advisor, moral integrity. Indeed, there can be no children without parents, nor a young generation without the old generation. A society and a nation could not avoid chaos without its culture and social order being based on respect for the knowledge and the wisdom of its elders.

#### G. Respect the rights of others

To criticise someone who is better, to covet others' possessions and to steal the merits of others are the marks of an unscrupulous man. Mother nature does make claims to her domain, yet all creatures within it acknowledge her eternal accomplishments. To help others develop and succeed in life is a reward in itself and has a true value only if nothing is expected in return.

Throughout human history, people who in jealousy have stolen the recognition due to others and have stolen their possessions out of avarice have always left dark imprints of shame and dishonour.

#### H. Be just

To be correct and forthright is to live one's life correctly. Old sages used to say; "To common men, life is most valuable, and death, most fearful." However, a righteous man would value justice above life itself and would be willing to die rather than submit to injustice. Such notable figures as Baek-E-Sook-Je of China, Sung-Sam-Moon of Korea and Yoshida-Shoing of Japan all chose death in defiance of injustice, leaving to their posterity lasting examples.

Baek-E-Sook-Je lived in Chou period about 2,000 BC. When King Moo toppled the twenty seventh King, who was a very notorious tyrant, he refused to serve the new King, who usurped the throne by force and not by legitimate process; he eventually starved to death in a self-imposed exile in the Sooyang mountains.

Sung-Sam-Moon was an important minister of the King Se Jong, inventor of Han-Gul (Korean alphabet) in the 14th century. After the king died and the young Dan Jong became king his uncle Se-Jo conspired against the boy king and took over the throne. Minister Sung was later executed because of his persistent protest over the unlawful act of King Se-Jo. Yoshida-Shoing, one of the loyalists was also executed in protest when the Doku-Kawa military government, at the time, tried to abolish the Mei-Ji monarchy.

### I. Be frugal

Since ancient times, excessive luxury and pleasure caused the downfall of many kings and nations without exception and history is full of such examples. Persons in leadership in particular must learn to be frugal and live moderately. As the old adage goes “if the water is muddy upstream so it will be downstream.”

An extravagant leader will affect his subordinates in this same way and will bring more hardship to his subjects through increased taxation and bribery. During the Lee Dynasty of Korea, the king’s roving inspector, Lee-Mong-Yong, while travelling the countryside incognito, was invited to one of the lavish dinner parties of a notorious governor. In the middle of the feast, he recited his famous poem:

*The sweet wine you drink from the glittering cups  
Flows from the tears of people who toil  
The tender meat which fills the dishes of jades is torn from their aching  
flesh  
Merrier you laugh, sadder they will weep  
Louder you sing, more plaintive their lament.*

The governor and his cohorts recognising the true identity of the poet, became frightened and fled from the scene. Remember that there are tears and heartaches of many behind one man’s pleasure.

### J. Be discrete

In every thing he does a person must not be impulsive or reckless but be patient and thoughtful. “He who acts without thinking at least three times, will later regret his action,” warns an old proverb.

Accordingly, on a matter of an important appointment or punishment, one must not decide hastily but must deliberate to reach a decision that is both fair and objective.

### K. Know true happiness

Lao-Tzu pointed out that nature was based upon harmony in contrasts. For example, the universe was made up of two forces, Yin (female) and Yang (male). Other contrasts were hard and soft, long and short, night and day, solid and empty, cold and warm, big and small, beautiful and ugly. All things in this world are relative to one another. Misery can only come from having been happy once and sorrow from joy. The wealthy and the powerful are not necessarily happy. For every rich person, there are countless poor and for each tyrant, a nation of oppressed. Mencius defined life’s three happinesses as follows:

1. Healthy parents and harmony within the family.
2. To live with pride and honour through correct behaviour.
3. To educate the young to become upright and useful members of society.

#### L. Let your actions speak for yourself

Even the ablest orator is apt to err if given to verbiage. A closed mouth can save a fish from the hook as well as stay secrets from the enemy. To speak only what is meaningful is a sign of a cultivated person. People talk mostly to brag about themselves or to gain advantage over others.

A man of virtue expresses himself more through deeds than words. Thus, he influences others through living examples. In the old days, the truly effective way to teach was believed to be by the actions not by the words of the teacher.

#### M. Develop peace of mind

A clear pond becomes muddy if agitated and then returns to its original state when allowed to settle undisturbed. It is said that calm will be able to conquer the heat. Undoubtedly you can endure the hottest summer heat if you sit calm and composed. Conversely, if you move too much in order to warm your freezing body you may get temporary relief, but it does not last too long.

We can attain peace of mind through meditation, by emptying our minds of all petty thoughts and returning to the natural state of man. Unlike in Buddhism or Zen, meditation in Taekwon-Do does not mean a total divorce from the world, like a dead body, but rather an active moment to reflect on our past mistakes in silence and in the privacy of our thoughts, and through penitence, to continue our self-improvement toward becoming better men or women.

This active thought process in silence is called “Jung-Joong-Dong”.

#### N. Be of firm mind

A person of strong conviction is unsuspicious and unafraid. When proved wrong, he has the moral strength to admit his mistakes to even the most humble and has the courage to stand up to the mighty if he believes himself to be right in all matters.

Strong conviction can be gained through the broad and deep “Ki”- spirit. Ki is a form of active energy which fills every physical cell and organ while “Chi” (will) is the motivating force: the former moves and the latter leads. If “Ki” is nurtured with great care and allowed to grow based on humanity and justice, its soaring power and outreaching strength can fill the heaven and earth, enabling man to reach a new height of great achievements, so Mencius exhorted his disciples.

On a more practical level “Ki” helps us to keep our minds clear and alert when the affairs of life become strained and confused, or sees us through sleepless nights when our loved one is gravely ill.

O. Be devoted

As meditation is to the religious, concentration and devotion is to the artist, and perseverance is to the labourer, so is moral culture to the practitioner of the martial arts. In other words a person's unflinching dedication to his own interest and duty is the source of life and power. Cultivation of mind, therefore, is no monopoly of any particular person.

In fact the sincerity and effort definitely produce the belief and the belief makes one able to reach the final goal.

Moral culture is considered to be a cultivating movement to make one devote oneself to his work, whatever it might be, until his life and work become one.

### III

In summary, we can enjoy a greater freedom of action by preserving our basic nature while making ourselves impervious to the temptation of power, money and sex. A person who has attained this stage of self-cultivation is sometimes called a "Saint."

It must indeed seem like an impossible undertaking to a mere mortal. A mountain crossing begins with a single bold step and an ocean begins with each small stream.

As ancient proverbs say: "Where there is a will there is a way." "One should not look afar, when the way is right in front of you." "Even heaven can be moved if one devotes himself to his cause."

With a strong will and firm determination, it is within the reach of anyone who is willing to make the effort.

This moral culture is uniquely tied in with Taekwon-Do, not only for the eventual attainment of the highest goals in Taekwon-Do and the promotion of power, technique, and self-confidence, but also for the cultivation of character. Without this, the Instructor would be guilty of imparting a devastating force to those who could eventually become so enamoured of their newly found techniques they might very easily become bullies or use this knowledge as a means to achieve their personal ambitions.

Most Taekwon-Do masters and Instructors are more apt to put emphasis on this aspect of training rather than some of the more sensational training guides of running over rocky seashores, beating the fists against pebbles or thrusting them into boiling water, attempting to stop a bird in mid-flight, and so forth.

There are also a number of obligations the serious student must fulfil, and the following steps have been taken by each Taekwon-Do school under the International Taekwon-Do Federation to maintain the high standards of Instructors and students.

1. A close scrutiny must be made of the mental make-up and background of applicants before their admission to the do jang or school.
2. Orientation to patriotism, obedience, behaviour, practices, discipline, and humility must be undertaken.
3. Personal morals, sincerity, as well as techniques should be taken into consideration upon awarding the higher ranks.
4. Higher ranks who are found fighting should be punished by the local Taekwon-Do Association.
5. All black belts must register with the local Taekwon-Do Association and International Taekwon-Do Federation.

During training the student should constantly develop mental and physical discipline, and the following activities should be considered an integral part of this training.

#### Travel (*yo haeng*):

Patriotism can be gained by travelling to noted or historical areas. An American student once remarked after visiting Gettysburg and the site of General Pickett's famous charge: "The fighting spirit and courage they possessed to attempt to conquer an unconquerable position must have come from a loyalty all officers would like to achieve."

Students should seek out these monuments, study and attempt to learn from them.

#### Mountain Climbing (*dung san*):

This form of exercise not only develops important leg muscles, but also nourishes the spirit and promotes a feeling of victory and triumph, as illustrated in the well known Korean poem; "No matter how high the mountain is, it can be compared to a small tomb under the heaven. There is no reason why man cannot succeed if he desires to climb it. All too often, however, one claims it is too high to climb without even making the attempt."

#### Cold Showers and Baths (*naengsoo machal*):

By taking cold showers and baths or exercising on snow-covered ground in bare feet, students build tenacity and pride.

#### Public Service (*sahwe bongsa*):

By contributing labour to the community, especially to the poor or disabled, the student learns charity, humility, comradeship, tolerance, and a sense of generosity.



Etiquette (*ye jol*):

A high degree of etiquette should be observed by students, both inside and outside the do jang. This should be applied by lower ranking students to senior students while training, by higher ranking students to elder students outside of the training hall (do jang), and by all students when visiting another do jang. In all cases, emphasis should be placed on correct and proper salutation. It is a form of respect and courtesy in Western as well as Oriental societies.

It is indeed poor taste for a black belt to slight a beginning white belt who might very well be the Instructor's senior in both age and station. Students visiting other do jangs, whether they be Taekwon-Do or other martial arts, must pay proper respect and observe the traits of modesty and courtesy at all times.

- 11. Thesis:** A study on any Taekwon-Do related topic which would be of value to other Instructors and students and may be suitable for publication. Should contain original material. Length at least 3000 words.

### **WT Yudanja pattern Meaning:**

#### **TAEBAEK**

Taebaek is the name of a mountain with the meaning of “bright mountain”, where Tangun, the founder of the nation of Korean people, and the bright mountain symbolizes sacredness of soul and Tangun's thought of “hongik ingan” (humanitarian ideal). There are numerous sites known as Taebaek, but Mt. Paektu, which has been typically known as the cradle of Korean people, is the background of naming the Taebaek poomsae. The line of poomsae is like a Chinese letter, which symbolizes the bridge between the Heaven and the earth, signifying human beings founded a nation by the Heaven's order.

## 1. Time requirement:

An average of two 1½ hour training sessions per week for 4 years since being promoted to 4th dan.

## 2. Stances: a. Warrior ready stance A (*moosa junbi sogi A*)

- b. Parallel stance with X-backhand (*narani so kyocha sondung*)
- c. Double step jumping (*ibo omgyo didimyo twigi*)

## 3. Defensive techniques:

- a. X-fist checking block (*kyocha joomuk momchau makgi*)
- b. Waist block (*hori makgi*)
- c. Twin straight forearm checking block (*sang sun palmok momchau makgi*)
- d. Outward block and pushing block (*bakuro makgi wa miro makgi*)
- e. Arc hand rising block (*bandal son chookyo makgi*)
- f. Low side block and high side block (*najunde yop makgi wa nopunde yop makgi*)

## 4. Offensive techniques:

- a. Long fist punch (*ghin joomuk jirugi*)
- b. Flying knifehand side strike (*twimyo sonkal yop taerigi*)
- c. Twin side fist horizontal strike (*sang yop joomuk soopyong taerigi*)
- d. Side fist side strike (*yop joomuk yop taerigi*)
- e. Side thrusting kick (*yop cha tulgi*)
- f. High twisting kick (*nopunde bituro chagi*)
- g. Side front snap kick and wedging block (*yobap cha busigi wa hechyo makgi*)

5. Patterns: ITF:
- a. Yon-Gae Tul – 49 movements
  - b. Ul-Ji Tul – 42 movements
  - c. Moon-Moo Tul – 61 movements

WT Yudanja : Pyonwon-Meaning Vast Plain-21 movements

## 6. Sparring:

A good knowledge of all forms of sparring must be known.  
Testing requirements are at the discretion of the Examiners.

7. Self defense: Testing requirements are at the discretion of the Examiners.

- 8. Destruction:** Set by Examiner
- 9. Fitness:** Set by Examiner
- 10. Essay** Candidates must write an essay on a topic specified by the examiners. Length for the essay is at least 1000 words.
- 11. Theory:** All theory contained within the Colored Belt Techniques Syllabus Handbook, general knowledge of Taekwon-Do, plus:
- a. Pattern meanings

#### Meaning of Yon-Gae

Yon-Gae is named after a famous general during the Koguryo Dynasty, Yon Gae Somoon. The 49 movements refer to the last two figures of 649 AD, the year he forced the Tang Dynasty to quit Korea after destroying nearly 300,000 of their troops at Ansi Sung.

#### Meaning of Ul-Ji

Ul-Ji is named after general Ul-Ji Moon Dok who successfully defended Korea against a Tang's invasion force of nearly one million soldiers led by Yang Je in 612 AD, Ul-Ji employing hit and run guerilla tactics, was able to decimate a large percentage of the force. The diagram represents his surname. The 42 movements represents the author's age when he designed the pattern.

#### Meaning of Moon-Moo

Moon-Moo honors the 30th king of the Silla Dynasty. His body was buried near Dae Wang Am (Great King's Rock). According to his will, the body was placed in the sea "Where my soul shall forever defend my land against the Japanese." It is said that the Sok Gul Am (Stone Cave) was built to guard his tomb. The Sok Gul Am is a fine example of the culture of the Silla Dynasty. The 61 movements in this pattern symbolize the last two figures of 661 AD when Moon Moo came to the throne.

b. Ideal Instructor

Soldiers are as strong as the general who leads them, and, in a like manner, students can only excel under an excellent Instructor. We cannot expect a bamboo to grow in a field of reeds, nor can we expect to find an outstanding pupil under an unqualified teacher.

It is of particular importance that the two aspects of Taekwon-Do, the spirit and the technique, must be taught together. Therefore, a qualified Instructor must combine the qualities of a scholar and a soldier if he is to produce pupils of noble character and outstanding skills.

Such an Instructor must possess the following qualities:

1. Strong moral and ethical standard.
2. Clear outlook and philosophy in life.
3. Responsible attitude as an Instructor.
4. Scientific mind in matters of technique.
5. Knowledge of the vital spots of human anatomy.
6. Unshakable integrity in political and financial dealings.
7. Dedication to spread the art of Taekwon-Do throughout the world.
8. One who gains confidence from his seniors, is trusted by his fellow Instructors, and is respected by his juniors.

c. Student and Instructor Relationship

The following points should be observed by Instructors:

1. Never tire of teaching. A good Instructor can teach anywhere, any time, and always be ready to answer questions.
2. An Instructor should be eager for his students to surpass him; it is the ultimate compliment for an Instructor. A student should never be held back. If the Instructor realises his student has developed beyond his teaching capabilities, the student should be sent to a higher ranking Instructor.
3. An Instructor must always set a good example for his students and never attempt to defraud them.
4. The development of students should take precedence over commercialism. Once an Instructor becomes concerned with materialism, he will lose the respect of his students.
5. Instructors should teach scientifically and theoretically to save time and energy.
6. Instructors should help students develop good contacts outside the *dojang* (training hall). It is an Instructor's responsibility to develop students outside as well as inside the *do jang*.

7. Students should be encouraged to visit other *do jang* and study other techniques. Students who are forbidden to visit other *do jang* are likely to become rebellious. There are two advantages for allowing the students to visit other gyms: not only is there the possibility that a student may observe a technique that is ideally suited for him, but he may also have a chance to learn by comparing his techniques to inferior techniques.
8. All students should be treated equally, there should be no favourites. Student should always be scolded in private, never in front of the class.
9. If the Instructor is not able to answer a student's question, he should not fabricate an answer but admit he does not know and attempt to find the answer as soon as possible. All too often, will a lower degree black belt dispense illogical answers to his students merely because he is afraid of "losing face" because he does not know the answer.
10. An Instructor should not seek any favours such as cleaning the studio, doing repair works, etc. from his students.
11. An Instructor should not exploit his students. The only purpose of an Instructor is to produce both technically and mentally excellent students.
12. Always be honest with the students, and never break a trust.

### **WT Yudanja pattern Meaning:**

#### **PYONGWON**

"Pyongwon" means a plain which is a vast stretched-out land. It is the source of life for all the creatures and the field where the human beings live their life. The poomsae Pyongwon was based on the idea of peace and struggle resulting from the principles of origin and use. The line of poomsae means the origin and transformation of the plain.

**1. Time requirement:**

An average of two 1½ hour training sessions per week for 5 years since being promoted to 5th dan.

**2. Stances:** a. One-leg stance with instep to hollow of knee (*waebal sogi*)

**3. Defensive techniques:**

- a. Knifehand low block and inner forearm middle outward block (*sonkal najunde makgi wa ap palmok kaunde bakuro maki*)
- b. Palm obverse pressing block (*sonbadak baro noollo makgi*)

**4. Offensive techniques:**

- a. Vertical punch (*sewo jirugi*)

**5. Patterns: ITF:** a. So-San Tul – 72 movements  
b. Se-Jong Tul – 24 movements

**WT Yudanja :** Sipjin-Meaning Ten Progressing -28 movements

**6. Sparring:** A good knowledge of all forms of sparring.  
Testing requirements are at the discretion of the Examiners.

**7. Self defense:** Testing requirements are at the discretion of the Examiners.

**8. Destruction:** Set by Examiner

**9. Fitness:** Set by Examiner

- 10. Essay** Candidates must write an essay on a topic specified by the examiners. Length for the essay is at least 1000 words.
- 11. Theory:** All theory contained within the Colored Belt Techniques Syllabus Handbook, general knowledge of Taekwon-Do, plus:
- a. Pattern meanings  
Meaning So-San  
So-San is the pseudonym of the great monk Choi Hyong Ung (1520-1604) during the Lee Dynasty. The 72 movements refer to his age when he organized a corps of monk soldiers with the assistance of his pupil Sa Myung Dang. The monk soldiers helped repulse the Japanese pirates who overran most of the Korean peninsula in 1592. Meaning of Se-Jong  
Se-Jong is named after the greatest Korean king, Se-Jong, who invented the Korean alphabet in 1443, and was also a noted meteorologist. The diagram ( ) represents the king, while the 24 movements refer to the 24 letters of the Korean alphabet.
  - b. Philosophy of Taekwon-Do  
In recent years, there has been an upsurge in violence and a loss of morality in all levels of society, especially among the young. There are, of course a number of reasons for this.  
Many psychologists today feel that this problem stems from frustration. Analysts, on the other hand, point out that these misguided people are indeed a disillusioned segment of society searching for values and relevance in what they consider deceitful, materialistic, and absurd world of wars and decadence.  
Unfortunately, however, instead of constructively channelling their extraordinary energy and potential, far too many strike out in blind anger, destroying rather than building, or merely running away from it all by isolating themselves with drugs and their own worlds of fantasy. Presently, the tendency of “the stronger preying upon the weaker” appears to be at its peak. Frankly, the present world closely resembles a “corrupt age.”  
It is obvious that this phenomenon of society is not merely because of the struggle for survival, but mainly because of an overdeveloped material and scientific civilisation. The former misleads the young to the extreme materialism or egoism, while the latter seizes human beings with fear, though playing an essential role in public welfare.

Then what would be the remedy? Needless to say it is the development of moral civilisation - the proper mental states of a human being as the lord of creation, enough to prevail or at least keep abreast with the development of material and scientific civilisation.

The utmost purpose of Taekwon-Do is to eliminate fighting by discouraging the stronger's oppression of the weaker with a power that must be based on humanity, justice, morality, wisdom and faith, thus helping to build a better and more peaceful world.

All men, regardless of age, have felt that death is a shame and lamented that they cannot live as long as the pine trees or the turtles that seem to live a thousand years. Righteous men, on the other hand, deplore the fact that justice does not always triumph over the tyranny of power. However, there are two ways to deal with these problems: The former, through mental discipline, the latter, through physical training.

It is my firm belief that through Taekwon-Do, anyone can garner enough strength to become a guardian of justice, to challenge social disunity and, to cultivate the human spirit to the highest level attainable. It is in this spirit, I am dedicating the art of Taekwon-Do to the people of the world.

The philosophy of Taekwon-Do is based on the ethical, moral, and spiritual standards by which men can live together in harmony, and its art patterns are inspired by the ideals and exploits of great men from Korean history. Korea's famous military and civil leaders who in nearly five thousand years of Korean history have never invaded their neighbour yet who fought bravely and made great self-sacrifices to defend their homeland against invading enemies. I also include the names of patriots who willingly gave up their lives to regain Korea's freedom and independence from the Japanese occupation.

Each *TuI* (pattern) of Taekwon-Do expresses the thoughts and the actions of these great men, so the students of Taekwon-Do must reflect the true intentions of those whose name each *TuI* bears.

Therefore, under no circumstances should Taekwon-Do be used for selfish, aggressive or violent purposes, either by an individual or group. Nor will Taekwon-Do be used for any commercial or political purpose whatsoever.

I have set forth the following philosophy and guidelines which will be the cornerstone of Taekwon-Do and by which all serious students of this art are encouraged to live.

1. Be willing to go where the going may be tough and do the things that are worth doing even though they are difficult.
2. Be gentle to the weak and tough to the strong.
3. Be content with what you have in money and position but never in skills.
4. Always finish what you begin, be it large or small.



5. Be a willing teacher to anyone regardless of religion, race or ideology.
6. Never yield to repression or threat in the pursuit of a noble cause.
7. Teach attitude and skill with action rather than words.
8. Always be yourself even though your circumstances may change.
9. Be the eternal teacher who teaches with the body when young, with words when old, and by moral precept even after death.

### **WT Yudanja pattern Meaning:**

#### **SIPJIN**

The word “Sipjin” was derived from the thought of 10 longevity, which advocates there are ten creatures of long life, namely, sun, moon, mountain, water, stone, pine tree, herb of eternal youth, tortoise, deer, and crane. They are two heavenly bodies, 3 natural resources, two plants and 3 animals, all giving human beings faith, hope and love. The poomsae Sipjin symbolizes those things. The Chinese letter meaning ten is form of the poomsae line, which signifies an infinite numbering of the decimal system and ceaseless development.

## 1. Time requirement:

An average of two 1½ hour training sessions per week for 6 years since being promoted to 6th dan. Minimum age, 40 years.

## 2. Defensive techniques:

- a. Palm low inward block (*sonbadak najunde anuro makgi*)
- b. Twin palm horizontal block (*sang sonbadak soopyong makgi*)
- c. Bow wrist upward block (*sonmokdung ollyo makgi*)
- d. Knifehand circular block (*sonkal dollimyo makgi*)

## 3. Offensive techniques:

- a. Twin fist middle punch (*sang joomuk kaunde jirugi*)
- b. Backhand outward strike (*sondung bakuro taerigi*)
- c. Angle fingertip thrust (*homi sonkut tulgi*)
- d. Underfist front strike (*mit joomuk ap taerigi*)
- e. Twin side back elbow thrust (*sang yopdwi palkup tulgi*)

## 4. Patterns: ITF: Tong-il Tul – 56 movements

Tong-il denotes the resolution of the unification of Korea which has been divided since 1945. The diagram symbolizes the homogenous race.

**WT Yudanja** : Jitae- Meaning Earth- 28 movements

### WT Yudanja pattern Meaning:

#### JITAE

The word “Jitae” means a man standing on the ground with the two feet, looking over the sky. A man on the earth represents the way of struggling for human life, such as kicking, treading and jumping on the ground. Therefore, the poomsae symbolizes various aspects occurring in the course of human being’s struggle for existence. The poomsae line signifies a man standing on the earth to spring up toward the heaven.

### WT Yudanja forms past 6th Dan: Meanings found on pg. 51

- **7th Dan:** Chonkwon- Meaning Heaven's Power- 26 movements
- **8th Dan:** Hansu- Meaning Source Power- 27 Movements
- **9th Dan:** Ilyeo-Meaning Oneness-23 Movements

## **WT Yudanja pattern past 6th Dan Meaning:**

### **CHEONKWON**

The word “Cheonkwon” means the Heaven’s Great Mighty, which is the origin of all the creature and itself the cosmos. Its infinite competence signifies the creation, change and completion. Human beings have used the name of Heaven for all principal earthly shapes and meanings because they felt afraid of the Heaven’s mighty. Over 9,000 years ago, the founder of the Korean people, “Cheonkwon”, was meant by the heavenly king. He settled down in the heavenly town as the capital near the heavenly sea and heavenly mountain, where the Han people as the heavenly race gave birth to the proper thought and actions from which Taekwondo was originated. The characteristics of movements are large actions and arm actions forming gentle curves, thus symbolizing the greatness of Cheonkwon thought. The poomsae line “T” symbolizes a man coming down from the heaven, submitting to the will of Heaven, being endowed power by the Heaven and worshipping the Heaven, which means the oneness between the Heaven and a human being.

### **HANSU**

The word “Hansu” means water which is the source of substance preserving the life and growing all the creatures. Hansu symbolizes birth of a life and growth, strongness and weakness, magnanimity, harmony, and adaptability. Especially, “han” has the various meanings, namely, the name of a country, numerousness, largeness, evenness, longness, even the heaven, and the root of everything among others. Above all, the nature of water characterized by unbreakability and flexibility, in addition to all of the above significances, is the background of organizing this poomsae. Actions should be practiced softly like water but continuously like a drop of water gathering to make the ocean. The poomsae line symbolizes the Chinese letter which means water.

### **ILYEO**

“Ilyeo” means the thought of a great Buddhist priest of Silla Dynasty, Saint Wonhyo, which is characterized by the philosophy of oneness of mind (spirit) and body (material). It teaches that a point, a line or a circle ends up after all in one. Therefore, the poomsae Ilyeo represents the harmonization of spirit and body, which is the essence of martial art, after a long training of various types of techniques and spiritual cultivation for completion of Taekwondo practice. The line of poomsae symbolizes the Buddhist mark (swastika), in commemoration of Saint Wonhyo, which means a state of perfect selflessness in Buddhism where origin, substance and service come into congruity. The ultimate ideal of Taekwondo can be found in this state. It is a discipline in which we concentrate on every movement leaving all materialistic thoughts, obsessions and external influences behind.

## **Appendix A - Black belt grading information and Responsibilities**

### **Grading format**

The TITF allows its members to practice and examine with either the ITF or WTF Tul (patterns). With the ITF Tul the school owner can choose to use the sine wave motion if they wish or exclude it. As school owners you are permitted to set your own belt requirements. To achieve a higher rank you will need to complete requires as prescribed by your examiner.

### **Age considerations**

For those under 18 years of age, hand destructions are not permitted, with the exception of the front elbow strike or in some cases, at the discretion of the instructor and sitting examiners.

For those over 40 years of age, or those with medical / physical reasons, the examiners may consider making adjustments to the breaking requirements, and in some cases accept substitute breaking techniques. In the case of substitute techniques, these must be submitted with the grading application for approval by the sitting examiners. Substitute techniques should be as close to the required techniques as possible. For example, the same kick performed at a lower height or modified in some way. Those over 40 or medical / physical reasons are also permitted to perform ITF Ko-Dang Tul instead of Juche Tul at the grading, although they must still know Juche.

### **Responsibilities of a Black Belt**

One of the greatest misconceptions within the martial arts is the notion that all black belt holders are experts. It is understandable that those unacquainted with the martial arts might make this equation. However, students should certainly recognise that this is not always the case. Too often, novice black belt holders advertise themselves as experts and eventually even convince themselves.

The first degree black belt holder has usually learned enough technique to defend himself against a single opponent. He can be compared to a fledgling who has acquired enough feathers to leave the nest and fend for himself. The first degree is a starting point. The student has merely built a foundation. The job of building the house lies ahead. The novice black belt holder will now really begin to learn technique. Now that he has mastered the alphabet, he can begin to read. Years of hard work and study await him before he can even begin to consider himself an Instructor and expert. A perceptive student will, at this stage, suddenly realize how very little he knows. The black belt holder also enters a new era of responsibility. Though a freshman, he has entered a strong honorable fraternity of the black belt holders of the entire world; and his actions inside and outside the training hall will be carefully scrutinized. His conduct will reflect on all black belt holders and he must constantly strive to set an example for all grade holders. Some will certainly advance into the expert stages. However, far too many will believe the misconception and will remain in novice, mentally and technically.

**Those unable to undertake to these commitments should re-assess whether they are prepared to take on the responsibility of being a black belt.**

### **Dan Certificates**

Will be issued directly from the TITF headquarters.

## Appendix B- TITF Dan Structure

### Black Belt-Dan layout:



- Anything under 16 years of age is Junior Black. Dan certificates exactly the same, just belt has white stripe in middle. No retest required when they reach adult.

### Uniforms:

- TITF accepts ITF style or WTF Kukkiwon style uniforms with TITF patch on left side over heart.

### Dan Instructor Level Titles and Abilities:

- Any black belt rank without completion of an International Instructors Course (IIC) is national instructor. Can only award up to 1st Gup and only in the country your license is issued.
- Only the president can issue 8th and 9th Dan based on dedication to the art and the federation.

**IX-9th Dan:** *Grand Master Instructor/Saseungnim*- Can promote up to 7th Dan with permission of the HQ TITF.

**VIII-8th Dan :** *Senior Master Instructor/Sahyunnim*- Can promote up to 6th Dan.

**VII-7th Dan:** *Master International Instructor/Sahyunnim*-Can promote up to 5th Dan.

**VI-6th Dan:** *Senior International Instructor/Sabumnim*-Can promote up to 4<sup>th</sup> Dan.

**V-5th Dan:** *International Instructor/Sabumnim*- Can promote up to 3rd Dan.

**IV 4th Dan:** *International Instructor/Sabumnim*- Can promote up to 2nd Dan.

**III-3rd Dan:** *National Instructor/Sabumnim*- Can promote up to 1st Dan after completion of an IIC.

**II-2nd Dan:** *National Instructor/Boosabumnim*- Can promote up to 1st Gup

**I-1st Dan:** *National Instructor/Boosabumnim*- Can promote up to 1st Gup.

## Sources:

Black Belt Techniques Hand Book, ITNZ-Master Paul McPhail, 8th Dan

ITF Taekwon-Do Condensed Encyclopedia-General Choi Hong Hi, Founder of Taekwon-Do

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